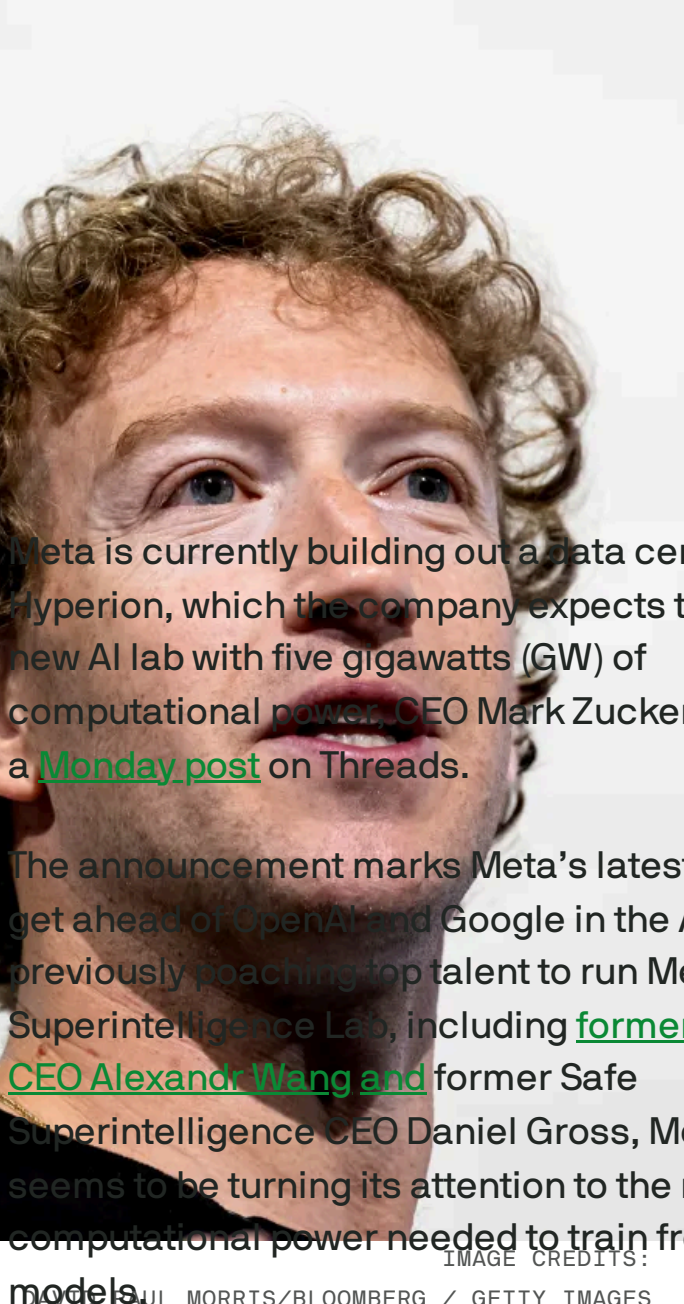


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AI



**Mark Zuckerberg says
Meta is building a 5GW AI
data center**



Meta is currently building out a data center, called Hyperion, which the company expects to supply its new AI lab with five gigawatts (GW) of computational power, CEO Mark Zuckerberg said in a [Monday post](#) on Threads.

The announcement marks Meta's latest move to get ahead of OpenAI and Google in the AI race. After previously poaching top talent to run Meta Superintelligence Lab, including [former Scale AI CEO Alexandr Wang](#) and former Safe Superintelligence CEO Daniel Gross, Meta now seems to be turning its attention to the massive computational power needed to train frontier AI models.

IMAGE CREDITS:
DAVID PAUL MORRIS/BLOOMBERG / GETTY IMAGES

Zuckerberg said Hyperion's footprint will be large enough to cover most of Manhattan. Meta spokesperson Ashley Gabriel told TechCrunch via email that Hyperion will be located in Louisiana, likely in Richland Parish [where Meta previously announced a \\$10 billion data center development](#). Gabriel says Meta plans to bring two gigawatts of data center capacity online by 2030 with Hyperion, but that it would scale to five gigawatts in several years.

Zuckerberg also noted that Meta plans to bring a 1 GW super cluster, called Prometheus, online in 2026, making it one of the first tech companies to control an AI data center of this size. Gabriel says Prometheus is located in New Albany, Ohio.

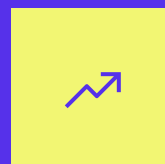
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Meta's AI data center build-out seems likely to make the company more competitive with OpenAI, Google DeepMind, and Anthropic in its ability to train and serve leading AI models. It's possible the effort could also help Meta attract additional talent, who may be drawn to work at a company with the computational needs to compete in the AI race.

Together, Prometheus and Hyperion will soak up enough energy to power millions of homes, which could pull significant amounts of electricity and water from neighboring communities. One of Meta's data center projects in Newton County, Georgia, has already [caused the water taps to run dry in some residents' homes](#), The New York Times reported Monday.

Other AI data center projects may cause similar problems for people living near them. AI hyperscaler CoreWeave is planning a data center expansion that is [projected to double the electricity needs](#) of a city near Dallas, Texas, according to Bloomberg.

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Nevertheless, tech companies are determined to build out massive data center projects to power their AI ambitions. Other notable efforts include [OpenAI's Stargate project with Oracle and SoftBank](#), as well as [xAI's Colossus supercomputer](#).

The Trump administration has largely championed the tech industry's AI data center buildout. President Donald Trump helped OpenAI announce its Stargate project, and has since spoken about efforts to expand America's AI infrastructure.

In a column featured in The Economist on Monday, U.S. Secretary of Energy Chris Wright called for the U.S. to "[lead the next major energy-intensive frontier: artificial intelligence](#)." He noted that AI transforms electricity into the "most valuable output imaginable: intelligence," and that the federal government would accelerate the production of energy derived from coal, nuclear, geothermal, and natural gas.

With the support of federal officials, the AI industry seems poised to soak up much of America's energy in the years to come. Experts estimate that [data centers could account for 20% of America's energy consumption](#) by 2030, up from just 2.5% in 2022. Without rapidly increased energy production, that could cause even more problems for communities.

Topics: [AI](#) [AI data center](#) [Climate](#) [climate](#) [Meta](#)





Maxwell Zeff

Senior AI Reporter | [X](#)

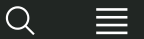
Maxwell Zeff is a senior reporter at TechCrunch specializing in AI. Previously with Gizmodo, Bloomberg,...

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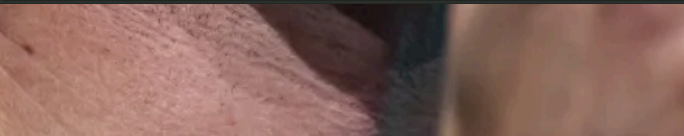
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Maxwell Zeff 4:15 AM EDT · April 29, 2023

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On Tuesday, Meta is hosting LlamaCon, its first-ever AI developer event. It'll center around the company's Llama family of open AI models, and we're expecting some big updates for developers. Also on the agenda: keynotes from Meta executives

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and fireside chats with Big Tech CEOs and Meta's chief, Mark Zuckerberg.

Meta is hosting a small number of developers and journalists at its Menlo Park, California, headquarters. The company is also livestreaming the big keynotes and firesides for people around the world to tune in. LlamaCon will stream on the [Meta for Developers Facebook Page](#) and on the [Meta Developers YouTube channel](#).

LlamaCon kicks off at 10:15 a.m. PT with a keynote speech delivered by Meta's chief product officer, Chris Cox; the company's vice president of AI, Manohar Paluri; and Meta generative AI research scientist Angela Fan.

At 10:45 a.m. PT, Zuckerberg will sit down for a fireside chat with Databricks co-founder and CEO Ali Ghodsi to chat about open source AI and AI-powered applications. What's the connection between Meta and Databricks? In January, Databricks announced that Meta was [backing the data-focused AI startup as a "strategic investor."](#)

Later in the day, at 4 p.m. PT, Zuckerberg will participate in another fireside chat with Microsoft CEO Satya Nadella. The two CEOs are slated to discuss the latest trends in AI and offer advice for how developers can stay ahead in the fast-moving AI space.

Stakes are high for Meta going into LlamaCon. The company recently [launched Llama 4](#), a new generation of AI models that was met with a muted reaction from developers. The Llama 4 models were not state-of-the-art on certain benchmarks compared to leading AI models from DeepSeek, OpenAI, Anthropic, and Google.

Soon after the launch, Meta had to [fend off allegations that it cheated on a popular](#)

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[crowdsourced AI benchmark](#), LM Arena. The company used a version of its Llama 4 Maverick model “[optimized for conversationality](#)” to achieve a high score on LM Arena but released a [different version](#) of Maverick publicly.



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With LlamaCon, Meta is hoping to get back into the good graces of developers. We’ll see if the company can achieve that.

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Maxwell Zeff

Senior AI Reporter |

Maxwell Zeff is a senior reporter at TechCrunch specializing in AI. Previously with Gizmodo, Bloomberg,...

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AI



Sam Altman says Meta tried and failed to poach OpenAI's talent with \$100M offers

Maxwell Zeff — 3:31 PM PDT · June 17, 2025

IMAGE CREDITS: KEVIN DIETSCH / GETTY IMAGES

Meta CEO Mark Zuckerberg has been on something of a hiring spree lately, trying to staff up [Meta's new superintelligence team](#) with top-tier AI researchers from competing labs. To work on a team led by [former Scale AI CEO Alexandr Wang](#) and at a desk physically near Zuckerberg, Meta has reportedly offered employees from OpenAI and Google DeepMind [compensation packages worth upwards of \\$100 million](#).

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OpenAI CEO Sam Altman confirmed those reports on a podcast with his brother, Jack Altman, which was [published on Tuesday](#). However, the OpenAI CEO noted that Zuckerberg's recruiting efforts have been largely unsuccessful and made sure to throw a few more digs at Meta in the process.

New episode of Uncapped with [@sama](#). Enjoy 😊
pic.twitter.com/2lxYt3B4Gm

— Jack Altman (@jaltma) [June 17, 2025](#)

“[Meta has] started making these, like, giant offers to a lot of people on our team,” Sam Altman said on the podcast. “You know, like, \$100 million signing bonuses, more than that [in] compensation per year [...] I’m really happy that, at least so far, none of our best people have decided to take him up on that.”

The OpenAI CEO said he believed his employees made the assessment that OpenAI had a better chance of achieving AGI and may one day be the more valuable company. He also said he believes Meta's focus on high compensation packages for employees, rather than the mission of delivering AGI, would likely not create a great culture.

Meta reportedly tried to [poach](#) one of OpenAI's lead researchers, Noam Brown, as well as Google's AI architect, Koray Kavukcuoglu. However, both efforts were unsuccessful.

Sam Altman went on to say he believes OpenAI's culture of innovation has been a major key to its success, and that Meta's “current AI efforts have not worked as well as they hoped.” The OpenAI CEO said he respects many things about Meta but noted he doesn't “think they're a company that's great at innovation.” Later in the podcast, Altman said he believes it's not enough for companies to catch up on AI — they have to truly innovate to stay ahead.

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The OpenAI CEO's comments highlight some of the challenges that Meta has to overcome in order to build out a successful AI superintelligence lab. Besides bringing on Wang, Meta announced last week that it [invested significantly](#) in Wang's former company, Scale AI. The company has also reportedly [nabbed a few star AI researchers](#), such as Google DeepMind's Jack Rae and Sesame AI's Johan Schalkwyk. But there's more work ahead.

TC

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In the coming year, Meta will have to staff up its new AI team while OpenAI, Anthropic, and Google DeepMind operate at full speed. In the coming months, OpenAI is expected to [release an open AI model](#) that's likely to set Meta back in the AI race even further.

Later on in the podcast, Sam Altman described an AI-powered social media feed that seems likely to encroach on Meta's apps. The OpenAI CEO said he's curious about exploring a social media app that uses AI to deliver custom feeds based on what

users want, rather than the default, algorithmic feed that exists on traditional social media apps.

OpenAI is reportedly [working on a social networking app](#) internally. Meanwhile, Meta is experimenting with an AI-powered social network through its Meta AI app. However, it seems that some users are confused by the Meta AI app and have shared some [hyperpersonal chats with the broader world](#).

Whether AI-powered social networks take off remains to be seen. In the meantime, Zuckerberg and Sam Altman seem poised to butt heads over the AI talent race.

Topics: [AI](#) [Meta](#) [OpenAI](#) [sam altman](#)



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